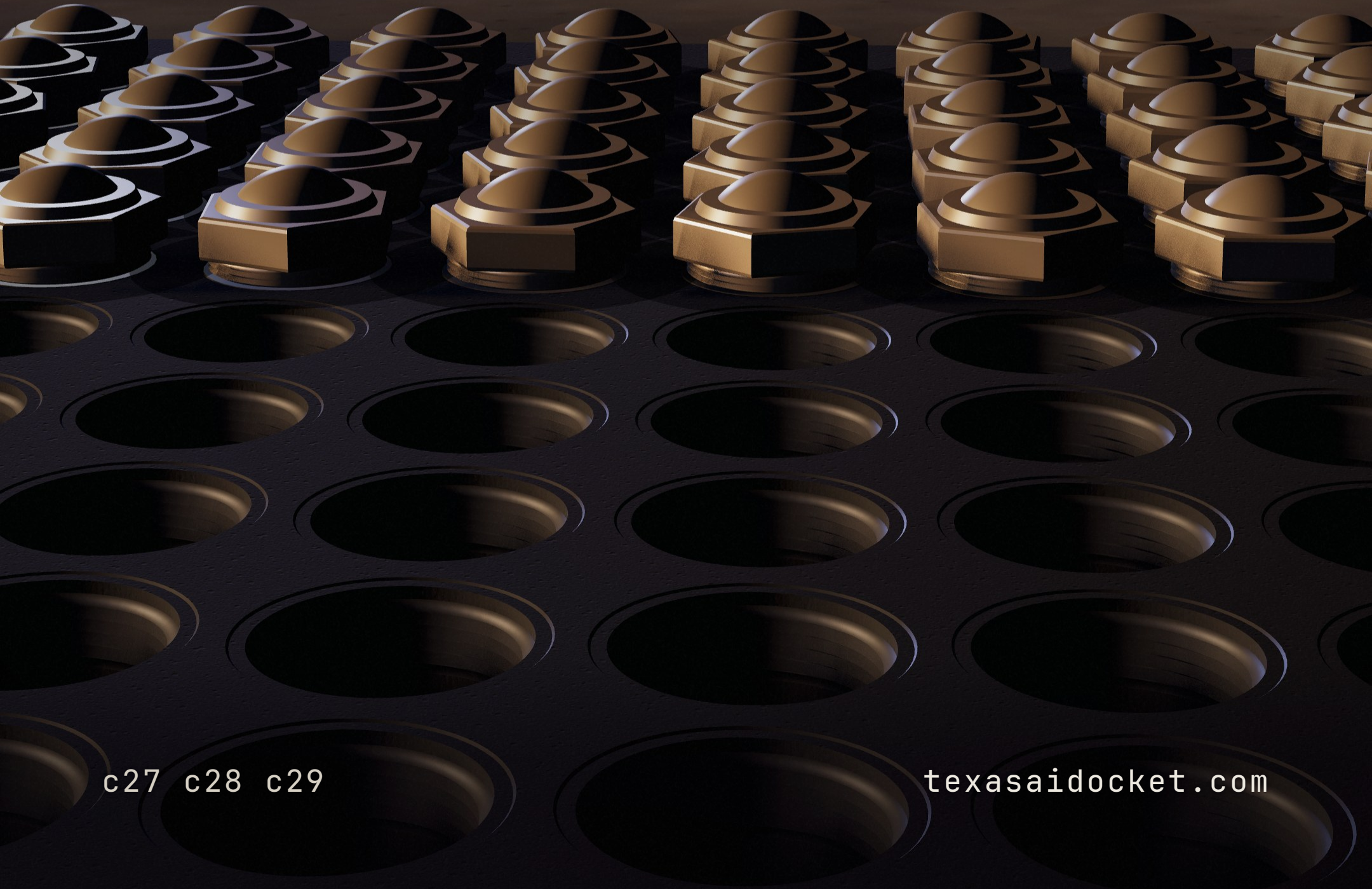
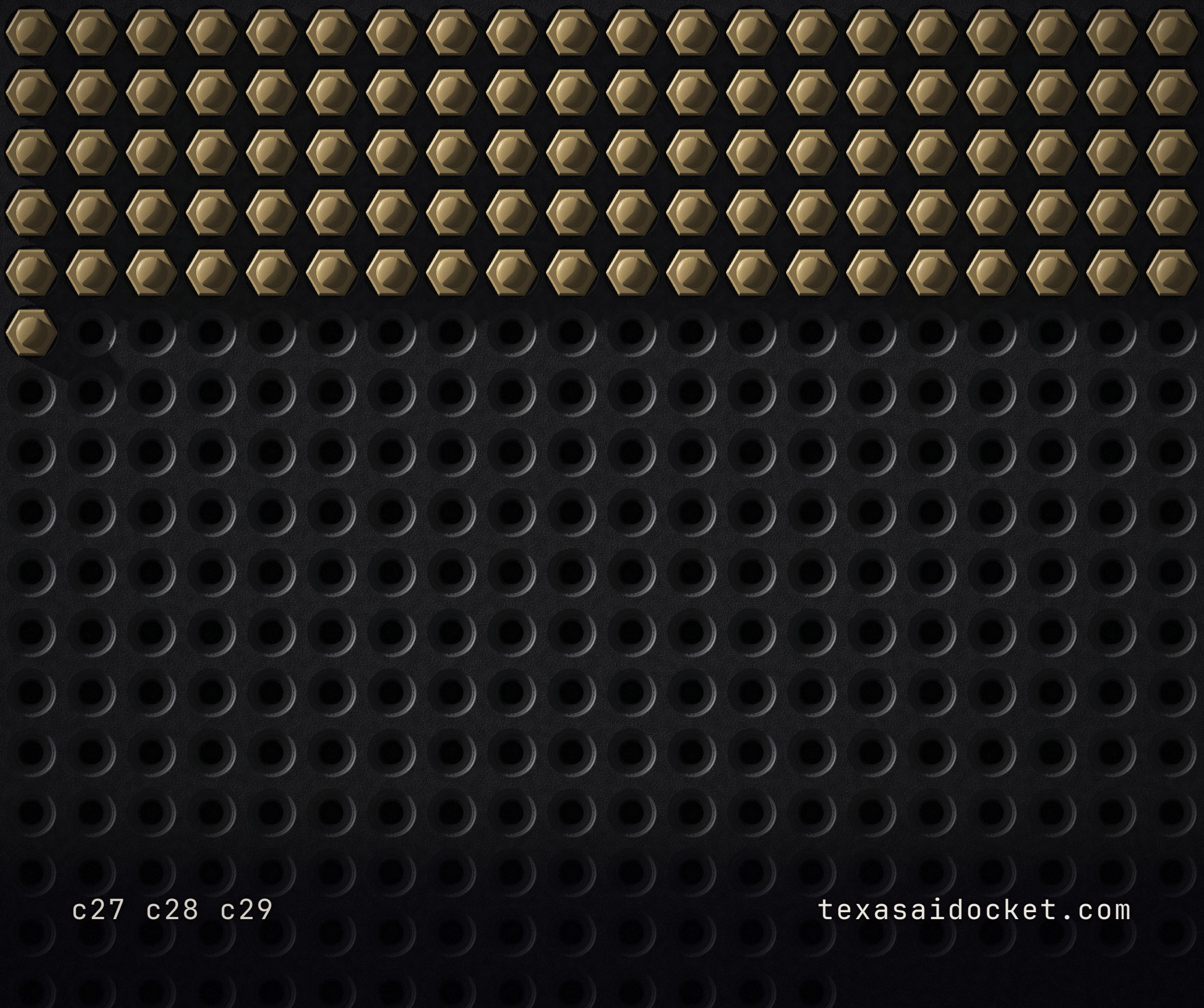
# Asked how much water they use, 233 never answered.

Records the Texas Tribune obtained for 2020 through 2025 count 334 data center facilities. Of those, 101 returned the water board's survey at least once. One bore for each facility, drawn to illustrate.



# 101 answered, 233 never did

A brass plug seals the bore of each facility that returned a survey at least once. No bore stands for a named facility. The plate is drawn to illustrate.



# Up to $500

Skipping the survey is a Class C misdemeanor, the Tribune reports. The water board says it has no authority of its own to prosecute. State officials don’t know whether any misdemeanor penalty has been issued against a data center.

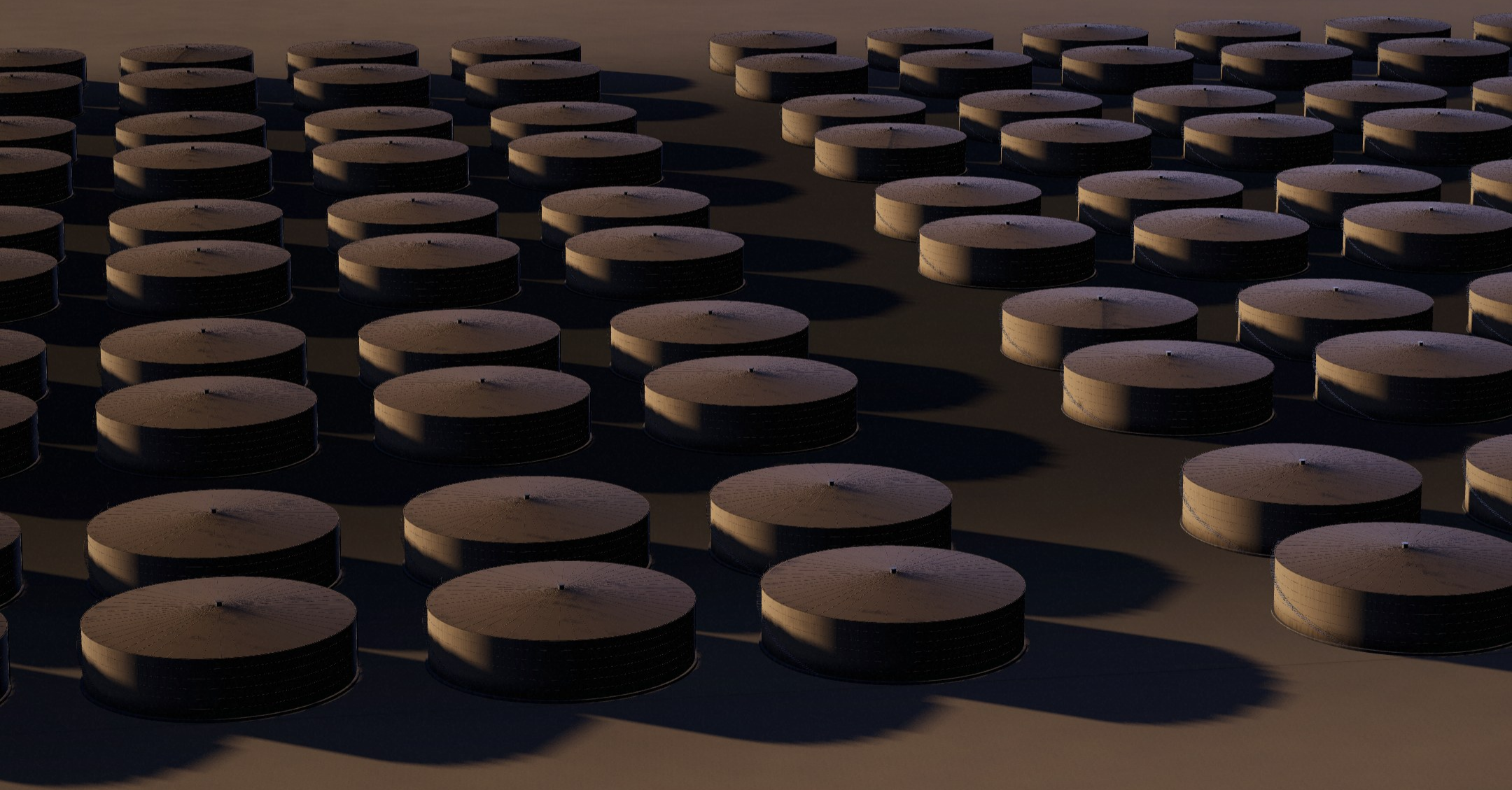
# The survey's line is 10 million gallons a year

It goes to operating facilities using more than that, the Tribune reports. This tank holds that much, drawn to illustrate. The survey doesn’t ask how a data center cools its servers.



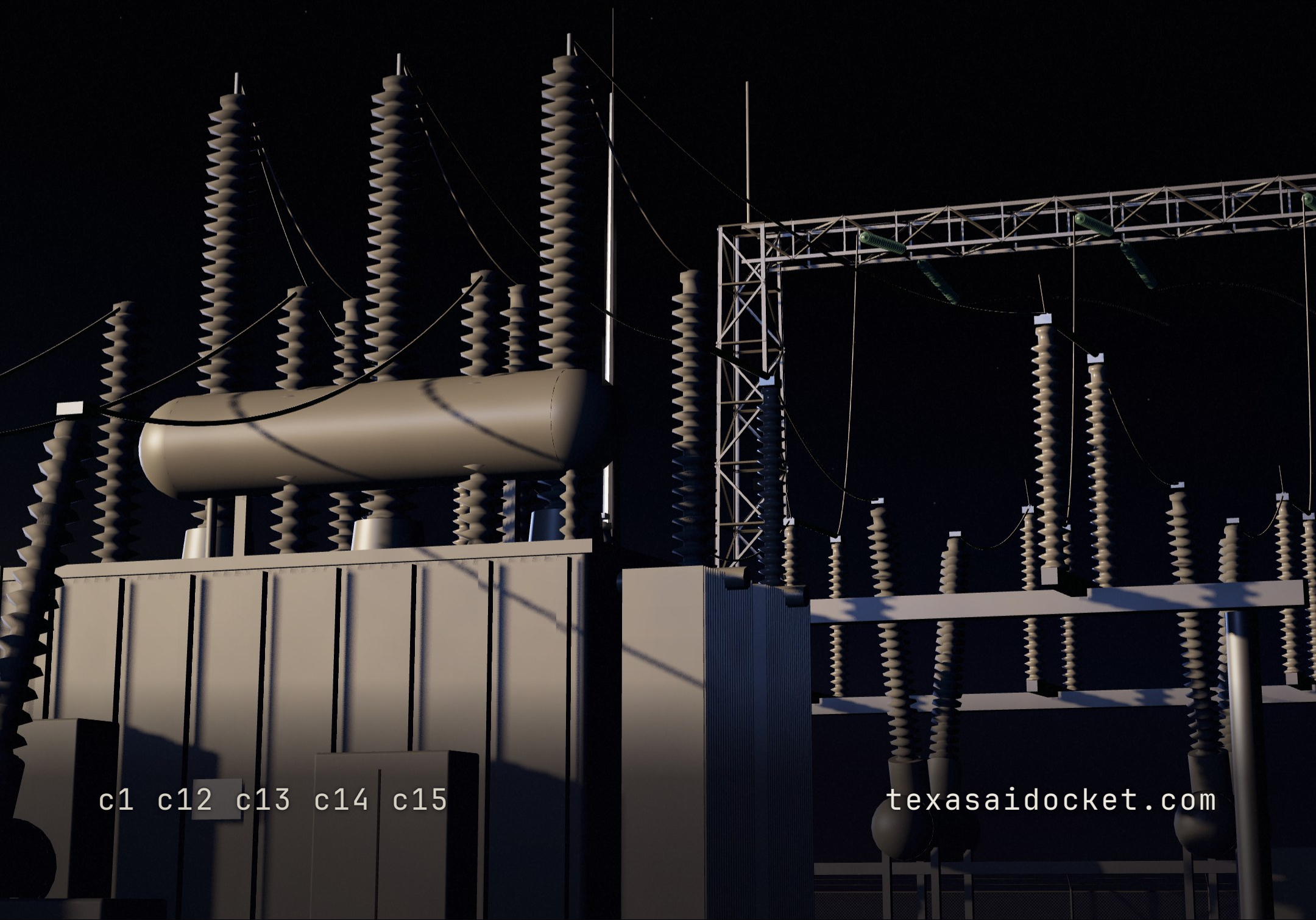
# 97 facilities reported 1.4 billion gallons

The Tribune reports the total from last year’s survey. That much would fill 140 tanks of 10 million gallons, drawn here to illustrate.



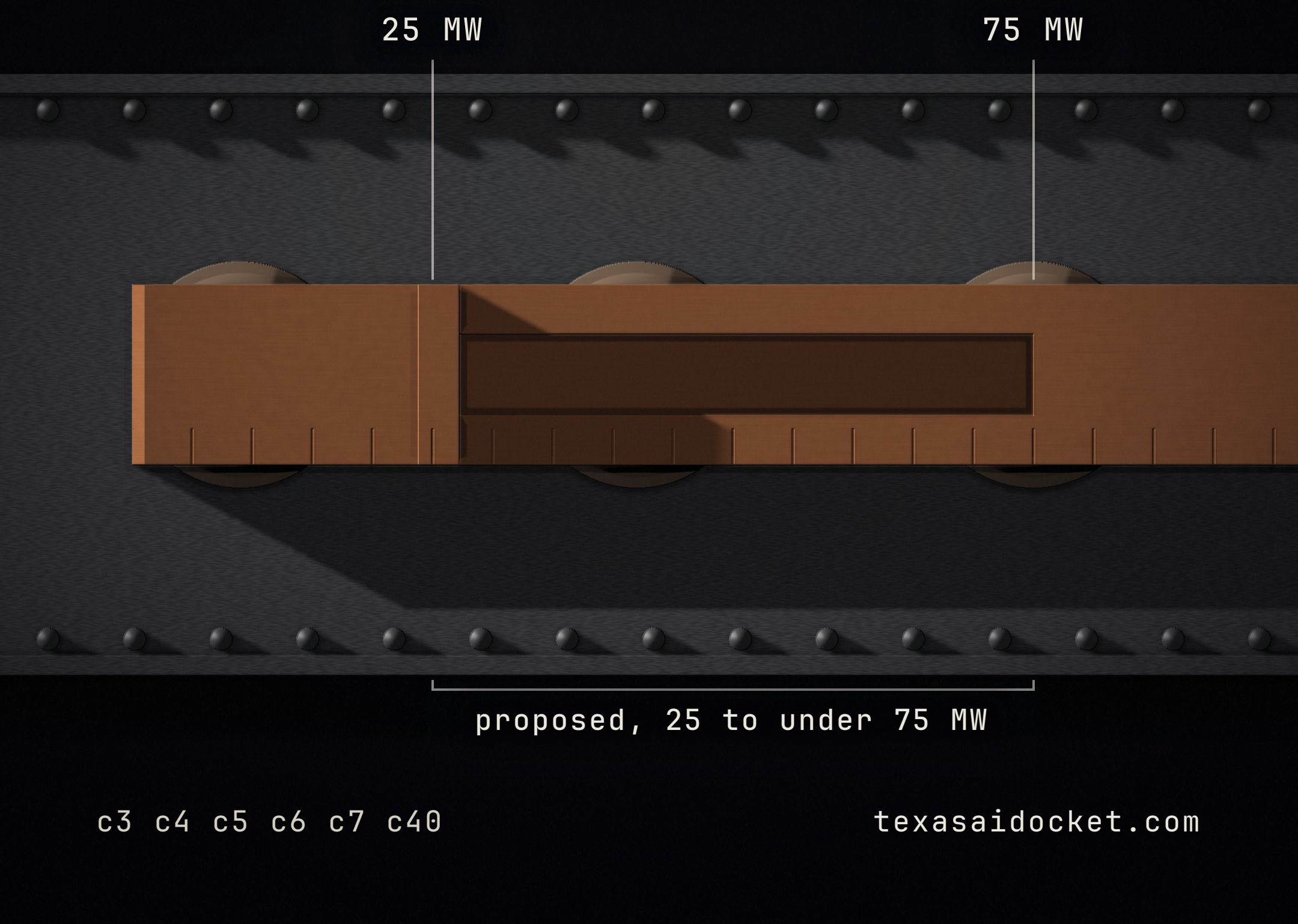
# Now the grid operator asks

ERCOT’s September 14th notice carries the water board’s questions in Section C, developed with the PUC and the board. ERCOT forwards the answers to the board. The transformer is drawn to illustrate.



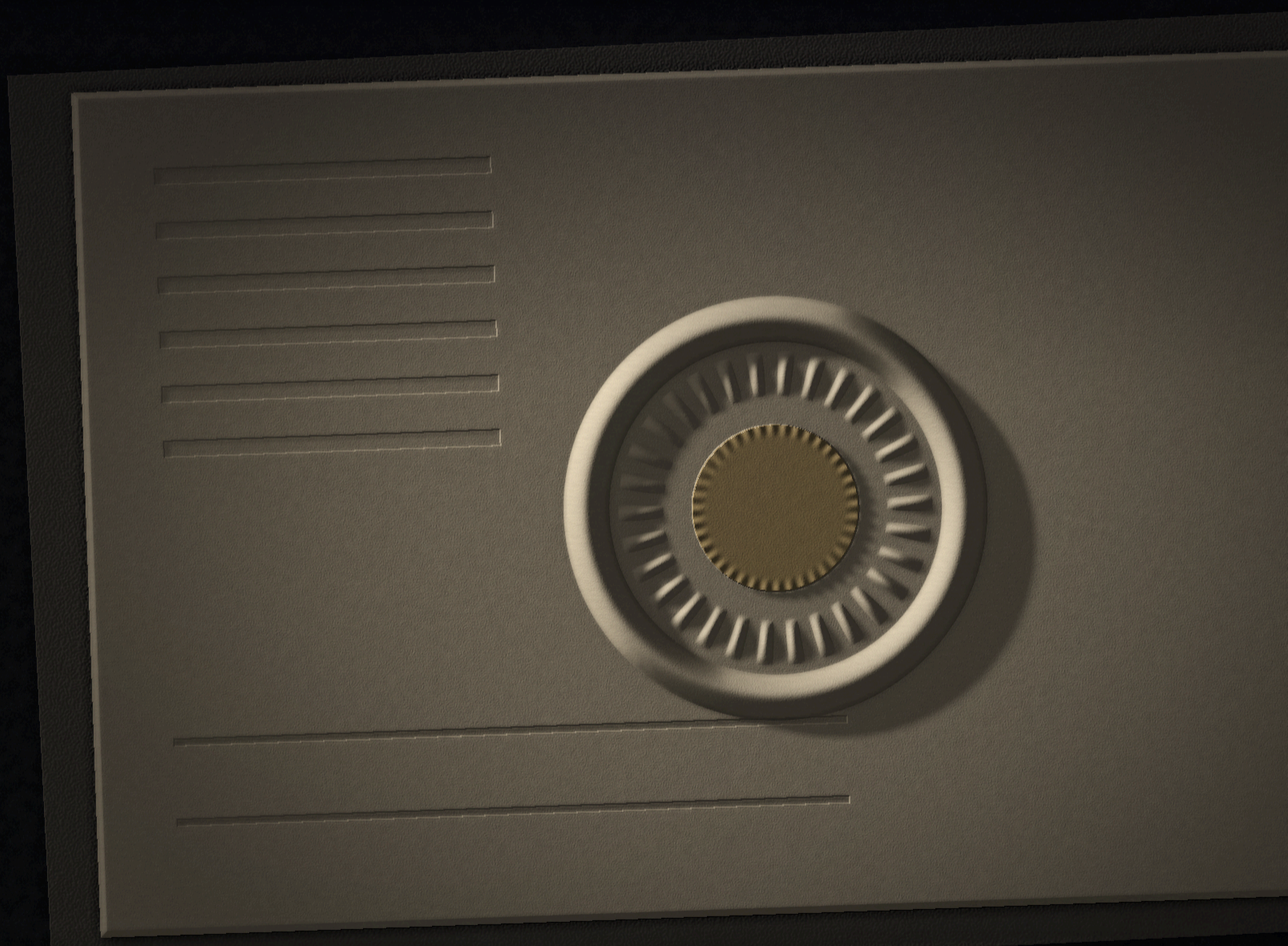
# The request reaches what isn't energized yet

It goes to proposed data centers of 25 to under 75 MW whose load is classified as Substantiated. It also goes to Batch Zero facilities or additions not yet energized at 60 kV or above. The survey goes to operating data centers.



# A notarized answer was due October 12th

The developer’s own utility files each response. A complete one carries a notarized attestation. A failure to respond is reported to the PUC and the Office of the Governor.



September 14th, the notice — October 12th, 5 p.m.

28 days

c1 c19 c20 c21 c23

texasaidocket.com

# ERCOT expects a report by December 10th

ERCOT says the report will set out conclusions from its own review, with the PUC. A case over a skipped survey is up to local officials, the Tribune reports. A bigger fine needs the Legislature, which meets in Austin in January.

